Hurricane Checklist

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/what-to-do-during-a-hurricane/, which lists its sources. Updated November 12, 2026.

Before the hurricane

- Find out whether you live in an evacuation zone, and plan where you'd go and how.
- Keep your gas tank at least half full during hurricane season.
- Cover windows. Permanent storm shutters are best; otherwise 5/8-inch exterior-grade or marine plywood cut to fit, the National Weather Service says.
- Bring in or tie down outdoor furniture, grills and anything the wind could throw.
- Stock at least 3 days of water (1 gallon per person per day) and food, plus medicines, flashlights, batteries, a radio and a first-aid kit. Plan for two weeks without power.
- Charge phones and power banks, and get cash.
- Bring pets inside and pack food, carriers and records for them.

During the hurricane

- **If ordered to evacuate, leave immediately.** See what to do when told to evacuate.
- **If you stay,** go to a small interior room, closet or hallway on the lowest floor, with as many walls between you and the outside as possible.
- Stay away from windows, skylights and glass doors.
- If the eye passes over, expect a short calm, then winds from the opposite direction. Stay inside.
- Keep a battery or hand-crank radio on for updates.
- If water starts rising in your home, move to a higher floor and call 911 if you can.

After the hurricane

- Return home only when officials say it's safe.
- Stay off flooded roads and washed-out bridges. Six inches of moving water can knock you down; 12 inches can carry away most cars.
- Stay away from downed power lines. Walk around the outside of your home to check for loose lines, gas leaks and damage before going in.
- Stay out of a building if you smell gas or floodwater surrounds it.
- Use flashlights, not candles. Turn the flashlight on before you go into a dark building, since a spark could ignite leaking gas.
- Never run a generator in your home or garage. See our power outage checklist for the carbon monoxide rules.
- Follow any boil-water notice, and throw out food that's been in floodwater or without power too long.

Hurricane checklist

- [ ] Know your evacuation zone, route and destination
- [ ] Gas tank at least half full
- [ ] Water: 1 gallon per person per day, at least 3 days
- [ ] Food that needs no cooking, and a manual can opener
- [ ] Medicines and a first-aid kit
- [ ] Flashlights, extra batteries and a battery or hand-crank radio
- [ ] Charged phones and power banks
- [ ] Cash
- [ ] Copies of insurance papers and IDs in a waterproof bag

- [ ] Window coverings ready
- [ ] Outdoor furniture and grills brought in or tied down
- [ ] Pet food, carriers and records

Tick items off on your iPhone. BugOut, the free offline survival app, lets you make your own checklists and keeps its guides on your phone with no signal.